

Community Outreach Programme

Date: 19 October 2025

Time: 1:00 PM – 6:00 PM

Activity 1: House Cleaning & Rubbish Removal

Summary

A request was received from a patient in her late 60s, who had been admitted to Wellington Regional Hospital and was known to Tony Thomas, a registered social worker at the hospital and trustee of St Mary's Syro-Malabar Mission, Wellington. The patient was living in an unsanitary environment with significant rubbish accumulation and foul odour. She was under the care of the community mental health team and suffering from chronic depression.

As part of discharge planning and to enable future district nurse visits, the house required a deep clean prior to the patient's return. Financial assistance options were explored through WINZ and NGOs such as Wesley Community Action, but the cost of professional cleaning services was unaffordable for the patient.

After consultation with the patient's community mental health social worker, Tony approached the Young Couples' Ministry of St Mary's Syro-Malabar Mission, but the request was declined. The SMYM group also declined due to prior commitments and the unsuitability of the environment for those under 18.

The matter was then discussed with Chaplain Joseph Kunnackattu, Trustee Joshy Abraham, Trustee Tony Thomas and former Secretary Joshua Jose, who kindly agreed to proceed with the work on behalf of the church due to the urgent nature of the situation. Formal written consent was obtained from the homeowner to enter the property and carry out the cleaning activity.

Activity Details

- Volunteers: Vinu, Joshy, Aquinas, Tony, Austin & Roni
- Tasks Completed: Approximately 15 large bags of rubbish were removed.
- Safety Measures: 4 volunteers working inside the house wore PPE kits, safety boots, masks and gloves.
- Duration: The activity took approximately 3.5 hours.

Documentation

- Photographs of the property before and after cleaning.
- Signed consent form from the homeowner authorizing the work.
- Receipts for expenses incurred.

Expenses & Balance

- Garden bag: \$28.48
- Petrol: \$20

- Rubbish dumping: \$84
- Rubbish bags: Provided at the house

Total: **\$132.48**

Balance: \$420-132.48= **\$287.52**

Outcomes & Community Impact

Following this event, the chaplain and trustees recommended that similar activities be continued as part of the church's Community Outreach Programme, designed to support struggling individuals in the wider community. They also agreed to seek further ideas and guidance from parish council members to expand and strengthen the programme.

To fund this initiative, a fundraising activity ("Spin the Wheel") was held during the church feast day, raising \$420.

A video presentation of the cleaning activity was prepared with the support of the SMYM team and published at the church on 23 November.

The initiative received wide appreciation and encouragement from parish members and was formally acknowledged by the manager of the surgical ward at Wellington Regional Hospital.

The patient herself expressed heartfelt thanks to the volunteers and to the St Mary's Syro-Malabar community for the effort.

Conclusion

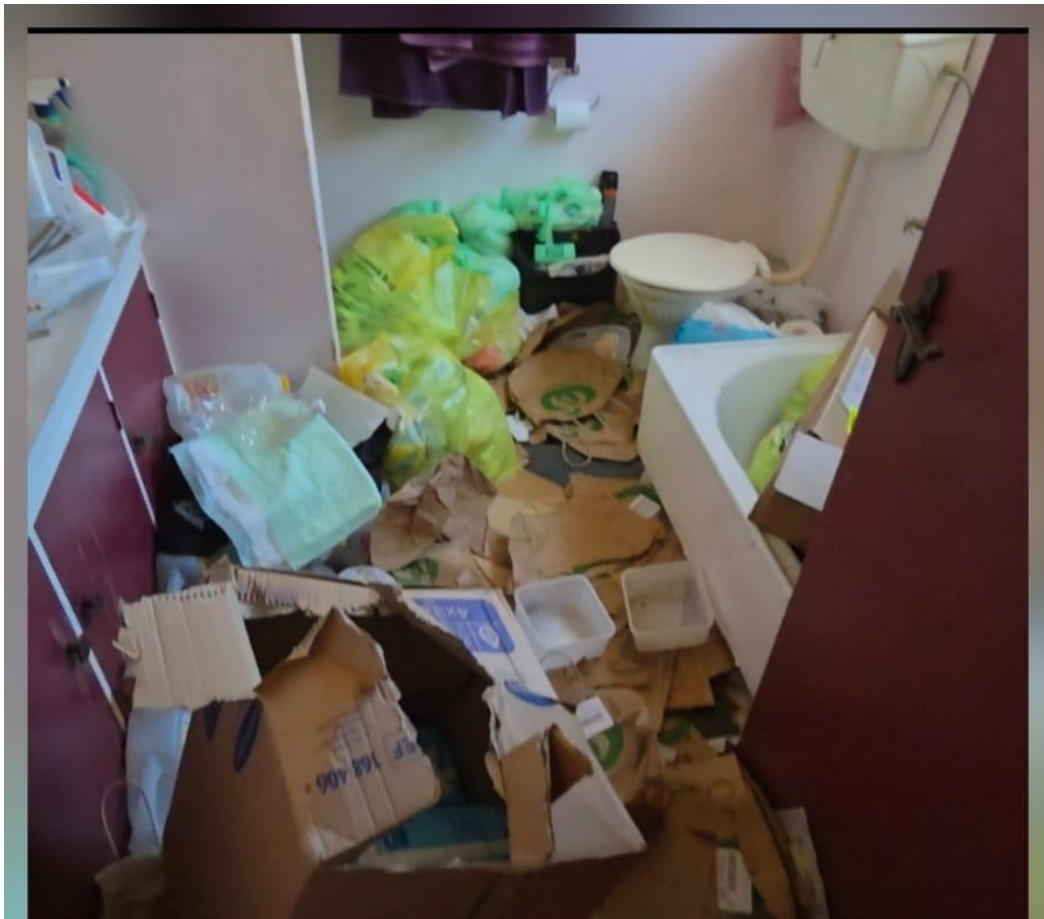
This activity demonstrated the parish's commitment to community service and highlighted the importance of collective effort in supporting vulnerable individuals. It also laid the foundation for ongoing outreach programmes that will continue to strengthen the mission's role as a helping hand in the community.

****DOCUMENTATION****

• Photos











• Receipts



\$84.00

Fri 03 Oct 2025, 4:15 PM

From

02-0576-0040398-000

To

Spicer Landfill

Payment type

EFTPOS

• Consent form

St Mary's Syro Malabar Mission Wellington

27 Trebann Street, Paparangi, Wellington 6037

Website: <https://smmissionwellington.org.nz>

Property Access and Cleaning Consent Form

Resident's Full Name: Jocelyn Mary Gerven

Resident's Contact Number: 027 644 7349

Property Address: 27 B Kingsbridge Place, Newlands

Date of Cleaning: Sunday, 19 October 2025

Time: 1:00 PM – 6:00 PM

Purpose of Visit

Volunteers from St Mary's Syro Malabar Mission Wellington will assist in clearing and cleaning the above property as a charitable act to support the resident's wellbeing.

Consent and Acknowledgements

1. Access Permission

I give permission for volunteers from St Mary's Syro Malabar Mission Wellington to access my property on the date and time specified above for the purpose of cleaning and rubbish removal.

2. Volunteer-Based Cleaning

I understand that the cleaning will be carried out by volunteers, not professional cleaners.

3. Future Deep Clean

I acknowledge that a deep clean will be arranged separately by my community social worker at a later date.

4. Liability Waiver

I acknowledge that St Mary's Syro Malabar Mission Wellington and its volunteers accept no responsibility for any pre-existing damage to the property or its contents, or any mental or emotional impact on my pets (including my three cats) as a result of the cleaning process.

5. Disposal of Items

I consent to the removal and disposal of rubbish and items deemed unsanitary or hazardous by the volunteers, except for the items listed below.

6. Items to Be Retained

Please list clearly:

Clothes
Handbag + contents
Boxes that seem to contain "non-rubbish"

7. Media Consent (Photos and Videos)

I give permission for photographs and videos to be taken during or after the cleaning process. These may be used for St Mary's Syro Malabar Mission Wellington's community outreach records and may be published on the church's website or social media platforms.

8. Data Privacy Notice

All media will be handled in accordance with privacy best practices. No personally identifiable information (such as names, faces, addresses, or other sensitive details) will be disclosed or published without explicit additional consent. Media will be used solely for the purpose of documenting and promoting the church's charitable activities.

9. Indemnity Clause

I agree to indemnify and hold harmless St Mary's Syro Malabar Mission Wellington, its trustees, volunteers, and representatives from any claims, damages, losses, or liabilities arising out of or related to the cleaning activities conducted on my property, including but not limited to any accidental damage, injury, or loss of property.

- Acc injury coverage discussed.
- [Signature]

10. Voluntary Participation

I understand that the cleaning assistance provided by St Mary's Syro Malabar Mission Wellington is offered on a voluntary and goodwill basis, and I am under no obligation to accept or continue receiving this assistance.

11. Health and Safety Acknowledgement

I acknowledge that I have disclosed any known health or safety hazards within the property (e.g., structural issues, presence of hazardous materials, or aggressive animals) to the church representative prior to the cleaning. I understand that failure to disclose such hazards may increase the risk of injury or damage.

12. Right to Decline or Cease Work

I understand that St Mary's Syro Malabar Mission Wellington and its volunteers reserve the right to decline or cease cleaning activities at any time if conditions are deemed unsafe or unsuitable for volunteer work.

Resident's Full Name: Jocelyn Mary Gerven

Signature: [Signature] Date: 17/10/25

Witness Name (Church Representative): Tony Thomas

Contact Number: 0272482270

Signature: [Signature] Date: 17/10/25